

Installing Excel and the Analysis ToolPak

Development Economics · Professor Silvia Prina · Fall 2026

Northeastern's Office 365 A5 licence gives enrolled students the full Microsoft 365 suite at no cost. Do this before the first session — about fifteen minutes, mostly downloading.

1 · Install Excel

- 1 Go to microsoft365.com (or myNortheastern → Self-Service → Microsoft Student Advantage) and enter your Northeastern address. You will be redirected to NU sign-in.
- 2 Sign in as `yourusername@northeastern.edu` with your myNortheastern password, and complete two-factor if prompted.
- 3 Click Install apps (top right), then Microsoft 365 apps.
- 4 Run the installer that downloads — the portal detects your operating system. Excel arrives with the rest of the suite.
- 5 Open Excel, accept the licence agreement, and sign in again with your NU account so the university licence activates.

Excel in a browser is not enough

microsoft365.com also offers Excel for the web. It will not work for this course: the Analysis ToolPak add-in below is desktop-only. Install the desktop application.

2 · Enable the Analysis ToolPak

Ships with Excel but is switched off by default. It adds the Data Analysis button.

Windows

File → Options → Add-ins → Manage: Excel Add-ins → Go...
tick Analysis ToolPak → OK

Mac

Tools → Excel Add-ins → tick Analysis ToolPak → OK

How to know it worked

A Data Analysis button appears at the far right of the Data tab. If it is not there, the add-in did not load — try quitting Excel completely and reopening it.

If something goes wrong

- 1 Sign-in loops or rejects your password: reset it at NU, then try again.
- 2 No Install apps button: you are probably signed in with a personal Microsoft account.
- 3 No Analysis ToolPak in the list: come anyway — we also show LINEST, which needs no add-in.
- 4 Still stuck: bring your laptop to DITI office hours.

Northeastern ITS guides (NU login)

"Install Microsoft 365 on Windows" · "... on a Mac"
service.northeastern.edu/tech

Help

ITS: help@northeastern.edu · 617.373.4357
DITI: nulab.info@gmail.com